

Pacific
GRAIN & FOODS, LLC

JULY 2017

A LETTER FROM LEE

Here We Grow Again!

Pacific Grain & Foods is now expanding into nut butters. We all grew up eating peanut butter and jelly sandwiches; as the "go to" meal. Today, with expanded tastes, allergies and availability of nuts and seeds, we are now roasting and processing these butters in a dedicated facility, to the specifications of our customer.

Over the years, we have learned that nuts and seeds are healthy. Peanut butter is no longer the only spread in town.

Most of us already know that eating fat and having ample amounts of healthy fats in our diet are beneficial for our health and not the cause of heart disease, weight gain, or increased cholesterol. There are many amazing varieties of nuts and seeds that can easily be made into a butter, such as almond, cashew, even sunflower seed butter.

We don't have to just spread these butters on bread, but they can used as thickeners in baking and cooking.

Nutritionally speaking, nut and seed butters, as a collective, contain 6-9 grams of protein per two tablespoon serving, are high in minerals and B vitamins. Some contain higher amounts of omega-3's, and all contain a small amount of fiber.

Lee G. Perkins
Managing Member



Nut Butters

ALMOND BUTTER

Flavor: This the second most popular nut butter, due to the abundance of almonds. Slightly sweet, nutty, even when blended in the "creamy" version, is still a little gritty due to the almond skins.

Nutrition: Loaded with vitamins and minerals—vitamin E, manganese, copper, phosphorus, magnesium, molybdenum, monounsaturated fats, fiber, and protein.

Special tip: Roast and eat whole almonds to give you more variety with culinary use and decrease the chances of the fatty acids going rancid. As with other nuts and seeds, almonds can help combat heart disease in multiple ways, and the skins in almonds contain a natural prebiotic, the food that feeds the good bacteria in the gut, win win!

Use with any and everything!

WALNUT BUTTER

Flavor: Dense, earthy, slightly bitter and nutty

Nutrition: Contains the highest amount of omega-3 fatty acids out of the nut butter family, also copper, manganese, molybdenum, biotin, B vitamins, protein, and monounsaturated fats.

Special tip: Walnuts have been shown to help with heart disease, may increase brain health and function, lowered risk of diabetes, fights inflamation and oxidative stress especially from antioxidants found in walnuts, and more. I typically buy these raw and unsalted to toast on my own when needed.

Use: Best when mixed with other ingredients, such as desserts, smoothies, etc.

CASHEW BUTTER

Flavor: The creamiest and possibly most expensive of all nut butters. Creamy, sweet, versatile, and can be transformed into a sweet, or savory butter, or spread. Roast all nuts at 320 degrees for 12-18 minutes on a cookie sheet to increase flavor and shelf life for up to two years in the freezer.

Nutrition: Copper, phosphorus, manganese, magnesium, zinc, protein, mono and polyunsaturated fats.

Special tip: If you soak cashews before making into a nut butter, you'll create a smooth cream like the Classic Cashew Cream and Sweet Cream, both of which taste amazing, but it's a different texture.

Use: Best mixed with other ingredients such as cashew creams, or added to any soup and smoothies to thicken.



Seed Butters

SUNFLOWER SEED BUTTER

Flavor: Nutty, rich, earthy, not as sweet as cashews or almonds.

Nutrition: B vitamins, vitamin E, copper, manganese, selenium, phosphorus, magnesium, healthy fats, fiber and protein.

Special tip: Sunflower seeds make an amazing flour to use in baking, light in texture, affordable, with a strong flavor. Try my Sunny Lemon Poppy Seed Muffins!

Use: As a dip for carrots, or other crunchy veggies and fruits.

PUMPKIN SEED BUTTER

Flavor: Depending on if you use raw, lightly toasted, or roasted, the pumpkin seed flavor will change. It's slightly sweet, bitter, and earthy (especially when toasted).

Nutrition: Highest in zinc than most other nut and seed butters, also contains manganese, phosphorus, magnesium, copper, zinc, iron, healthy fats, protein and fiber.

